

# IF YOU CANNOT MEET YOUR BASIC NEEDS

Emergency and escalation numbers for Albertans on AISH and ADAP · August 2026

## 1-866-644-5135 or 780-644-5135

**INCOME SUPPORT CONTACT CENTRE · OPEN 24 HOURS, EVERY DAY**

Emergency help with basic needs: food, shelter, transportation. Does not close on evenings, weekends or statutory holidays. Email: [css.iscc@gov.ab.ca](mailto:css.iscc@gov.ab.ca)

*“Any Albertan who is unable to meet their basic needs can call the 24-hour Income Support Contact Centre at 1-866-644-5135 for emergency financial assistance.”*

*Office of the Minister, Assisted Living and Social Services, July 2026*

## TWO THINGS THAT MAKE THAT CALL GO FASTER

**Apply online first, then phone.** Go to [emergencybenefits.alberta.ca](https://emergencybenefits.alberta.ca), apply for emergency food or transportation, then call the number above to confirm your eligibility. Benefits are issued by Interac e-Transfer.

**If a supervisor has already approved help for you,** say so. Give your first and last name and tell them there is a note on your file about approved emergency assistance. They will pull up the note and walk you through it. Without that sentence you are starting from scratch.

## OPEN 24 HOURS, EVERY DAY

|                |                                                                                                                                      |
|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 988            | Suicide Crisis Helpline. Call or text, any hour.                                                                                     |
| 1-877-303-2642 | Mental Health Help Line.                                                                                                             |
| 811            | Health Link. Talk to a nurse about a health concern.                                                                                 |
| 310-1818       | Family Violence Info Line. More than 170 languages. Chat online at <a href="https://alberta.ca/SafetyChat">alberta.ca/SafetyChat</a> |
| 1-800-387-5437 | Child Abuse Hotline. 1-800-387-KIDS.                                                                                                 |
| 1-888-456-2323 | Bullying Helpline.                                                                                                                   |
| 211            | Community and municipal supports in your area. Call or text.                                                                         |

## OTHER NUMBERS WORTH KEEPING

|                |                                                                                    |
|----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 780-644-4336   | Inquiries about referrals to ADAP employment services.                             |
| 780-427-2709   | Appeals Secretariat. Fax 780-422-1088.                                             |
| 1-877-759-6810 | Disability Income Assistance Application Processing Centre. Also 587-759-6810.     |
| 310-4455       | Alberta Connects, the general government line. Will route you to the right office. |

**Inside Alberta, dial 310-0000 first and any toll free number is free from any phone.**

# IF YOUR PAYMENT HAS NOT ARRIVED

*There is a ladder. The call centre is the bottom rung, not the only one. Work down this page.*

## STEP 1 · YOUR PROGRAM OFFICE

|                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1-888-644-1802</b> | <b>Northern Alberta.</b> Athabasca, Barrhead, Bonnyville, Cold Lake, Edson, Fort McMurray, Grande Prairie, High Level, High Prairie, Hinton, Lac La Biche, Leduc, Peace River, Sherwood Park, Slave Lake, St. Albert, St. Paul, Vegreville, Westlock. Email: northzoneaish@gov.ab.ca |
| <b>1-833-698-9959</b> | <b>Central Alberta.</b> Red Deer, Olds, Drumheller, Camrose, Stettler, Drayton Valley, Lloydminster, Rocky Mountain House, Vermilion, Wainwright, Wetaskiwin, Whitecourt.                                                                                                            |
| <b>1-833-382-4081</b> | <b>Southern Alberta.</b> Lethbridge, Medicine Hat, Brooks, Crowsnest Pass, Pincher Creek, Taber.                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>780-415-6300</b>   | <b>Edmonton region.</b> Email: aishedmonton@gov.ab.ca                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>403-297-8511</b>   | <b>Calgary region.</b> Also 1-866-334-6950. Email: calgaryaish@gov.ab.ca                                                                                                                                                                                                             |

## STEPS 2 TO 6 · WHEN THE PROGRAM OFFICE CANNOT HELP

|                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1-877-644-9992</b> | <b>Alberta Supports.</b> Monday to Friday, 7:30 am to 8:00 pm. They can route you and can tell you which office holds your file. Ask to have the matter escalated to a program supervisor.                                                                                                 |
| <b>780-643-6210</b>   | <b>Office of the Minister, Assisted Living and Social Services.</b> The ministry's publicly listed contact, not a client service line, so expect to be routed rather than helped on the spot. Routed is the point. Keep it short and stick to the facts.                                   |
| <b>780-644-5135</b>   | <b>After hours crisis and emergency benefits.</b> See page 1. Also 1-866-644-5135.                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Your MLA</b>       | <b>Constituency office.</b> A call from your MLA's office moves faster than anything you can do alone. Find yours at <a href="http://contact.assembly.ab.ca">contact.assembly.ab.ca</a> . They need your written consent to speak about your file, so ask for that form on the first call. |
| <b>1-800-272-8841</b> | <b>Office of the Advocate for Persons with Disabilities.</b> Also 780-422-1095. Email: <a href="mailto:advocate.disability@gov.ab.ca">advocate.disability@gov.ab.ca</a> . They cannot represent you, but they help you navigate the system and raise concerns.                             |
| <b>1-888-455-2756</b> | <b>Alberta Ombudsman.</b> Email: <a href="mailto:info@ombudsman.ab.ca">info@ombudsman.ab.ca</a> . For procedural failures once you have tried the program first. Slow, so not the tool for money this week, but it builds the record.                                                      |

## WHAT TO SAY

Most people call and describe how they feel. What moves a file is a fact, a date and a request. Something close to this:

*"My name is \_\_\_\_\_. My benefit payment was due on \_\_\_\_\_ and has not arrived. That is \_\_\_\_\_ days. I have called \_\_\_\_\_ times and have not been given an answer. I am asking for a payment date in writing, and for emergency assistance while I wait."*

**Two rules, every time.**

**Get it in writing.** Ask for the answer by email. A verbal promise from a call centre is worth very little three weeks later.

**Write down who you spoke to and when.** Name, date, time, what they said. Every call.

Keep this where you can find it. Put it on the fridge. Send it to someone who is not online.

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown — Advocate

St. Albert, Alberta | August 2026  
[albertadisabilitybreakdown@outlook.com](mailto:albertadisabilitybreakdown@outlook.com)

Numbers taken from Government of Alberta pages and from correspondence issued by the Office of the Minister and by the Disability Income Assistance program. Verified against [alberta.ca](http://alberta.ca) on August 10, 2026. Free to share. Free to print.